

History of English Literature - Important MCQs (Part 38)

Page 187 - Coleridge and Scott

Q1. Which of the following is true about Coleridge's literary work?

- A. He wrote hundreds of completed epics
- B. All his work is fragmentary
- C. He only wrote prose
- D. He never wrote literary criticism

Answer: B

Q2. Which of Coleridge's poems are considered to have a pathetic interest in connection with the tragedy of his ineffectiveness?

- A. The Ancient Mariner and Christabel
- B. Dejection: an Ode and Work without Hope
- C. Religious Musings and The Destiny of Nations
- D. Lyrical Ballads and The Prelude

Answer: B

Q3. Coleridge's historical importance is largely due to which poems that represent the triumph of romanticism?

- A. Dejection and The Thorn
- B. Lyrical Ballads and Endymion
- C. The Ancient Mariner and Christabel
- D. Tintern Abbey and Ode to Duty

Answer: C

Q4. Which domain did Coleridge take as his particular province in poetry?

- A. The supernatural treated in a purely poetic way
- B. The realistic depiction of factory workers
- C. Political satire
- D. Translations of Greek epics

Answer: A

Q5. Romanticism found a less subtle but far more popular and influential interpreter in:

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- A. William Wordsworth
- B. Samuel Taylor Coleridge
- C. Walter Scott
- D. Lord Byron

Answer: C

Q6. Where was Walter Scott born?

- A. London
- B. Dublin
- C. Cockermouth
- D. Edinburgh

Answer: D

Q7. Where did Scott spend much of his childhood learning to love the wild landscape and hearing Border stories?

- A. In the Scottish Highlands
- B. At his grandfather's home at Sandy Knowe
- C. In a London orphanage
- D. At Cambridge University

Answer: B

Q8. What book, read by chance at age thirteen, aroused Scott's passionate interest in ancient ballads?

- A. Lyrical Ballads
- B. Percy's Reliques
- C. Macpherson's Ossian
- D. The Faerie Queene

Answer: B

Q9. When Scott made excursions into the Highlands, what was his primary purpose?

- A. Romantic and antiquarian
- B. Commercial and financial
- C. Political campaigning
- D. Scientific observation

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Answer: A

Q10. In Scott's time, going into the Highlands was compared to:

- A. Stepping into the future
- B. Stepping right out of the present into the feudal past
- C. Entering a sophisticated urban center
- D. Traveling to a foreign country

Answer: B

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Page 188 - Walter Scott's Career

Q1. Politically, Walter Scott was a born:

- A. Radical
- B. Liberal
- C. Tory
- D. Whig

Answer: C

Q2. What effect did the French Revolution have on Walter Scott?

- A. It made him a lifelong supporter of democratic republics
- B. It deepened his hatred of democracy and threw him back on history and romance
- C. He ignored it completely
- D. It caused him to move to France

Answer: B

Q3. Scott's first important publication (1802-03) was:

- A. The Lay of the Last Minstrel
- B. The Lady of the Lake
- C. The Minstrelsy of the Scottish Border
- D. Waverley

Answer: C

Q4. What was Scott's first long poem, published in 1805?

- A. Marmion
- B. Rokeby
- C. The Lay of the Last Minstrel
- D. Christabel

Answer: C

Q5. Which of the following is one of Scott's romances in verse?

- A. The Ancient Mariner
- B. Thalaba the Destroyer

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C. The Lady of the Lake

D. Queen Mab

Answer: C

Q6. Which rising poet's dangerous rivalry compelled Scott to seek a fresh outlet for his genius?

A. John Keats

B. Percy Bysshe Shelley

C. Lord Byron

D. William Wordsworth

Answer: C

Q7. In what year did Scott produce his first novel, Waverley?

A. 1805

B. 1810

C. 1814

D. 1825

Answer: C

Q8. What misfortune overtook Scott in 1825?

A. He lost his sight

B. Financial ruin

C. He was imprisoned for treason

D. His manuscripts were burned

Answer: B

Q9. How did Scott react to his adversity?

A. He fled the country

B. He committed suicide

C. He showed himself heroic and worked to wipe off his immense indebtedness by writing

D. He blamed his publishers and gave up writing

Answer: C

Q10. Scott's 'romantic tales in verse' represent a natural development of the:

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- A. Old ballad and medieval romance
- B. Classical epic
- C. Augustan closed couplet
- D. Renaissance sonnet

Answer: A

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Page 189 - Scott's Limitations and Bowles

Q1. Which of the following describes Scott's limitations as a poet?

- A. He has no ability to describe landscape
- B. He rarely takes the reader beneath the surface of things and carries no weight of thought
- C. He is too mystical and obscure
- D. His stories are extremely boring and lack action

Answer: B

Q2. William Lisle Bowles is known for helping the growth of a love of nature in poetry through which work published in 1789?

- A. Lyrical Ballads
- B. Sonnets written chiefly in Picturesque Spots
- C. Pleasures of Memory
- D. The Prelude

Answer: B

Q3. Samuel Rogers, who wrote 'Pleasures of Memory' (1792), had a career outside of poetry as a:

- A. Clergyman
- B. Banker
- C. Physician
- D. Lawyer

Answer: B

Q4. Did Samuel Rogers' poetry reflect the new movements of literature?

- A. Yes, he was a radical romantic
- B. No, he remained practically untouched by the new movements and wrote in the 'correct' Augustan style
- C. He introduced the supernatural elements to English verse
- D. He exclusively wrote free verse

Answer: B

Q5. James Hogg was commonly known by what nickname?

- A. The Border Minstrel

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- B. The Scottish Homer
- C. The Ettrick Shepherd
- D. The Marvelous Boy

Answer: C

Q6. Hogg is considered the truest poet who has ever sprung direct from the Scottish peasantry after:

- A. Allan Ramsay
- B. Walter Scott
- C. Robert Burns
- D. James Thomson

Answer: C

Q7. Which of the following poems was written by James Hogg?

- A. The Queen's Wake
- B. The Minstrel
- C. Pleasures of Hope
- D. Marmion

Answer: A

Q8. Like Wordsworth and Coleridge, Robert Southey fell as a youth under the spell of:

- A. The Industrial Revolution
- B. The French Revolution
- C. The Gothic Revival
- D. Oriental mysticism

Answer: B

Q9. Which of these works by Southey were products of his youthful radical ideas?

- A. Madoc and Roderick
- B. Joan of Arc and Wat Tyler
- C. The Holly Tree and The Scholar
- D. A Vision of Judgment

Answer: B

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Q10. What genre is Southey's 'Wat Tyler' (1794)?

- A. An epic poem
- B. A novel
- C. A drama
- D. A lyrical ballad

Answer: C

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Page 190 - Southey and Landor

Q1. Like Wordsworth, Southey eventually repudiated his early radical ideas and became a:

- A. Radical Socialist
- B. Whig
- C. Tory of the Tories
- D. French sympathizer

Answer: C

Q2. Southey's ill-advised and ludicrous eulogy of George III, 'A Vision of Judgment', is remembered today mainly because of:

- A. Its profound theological insight
- B. Its flawless Spenserian stanzas
- C. Lord Byron's scathing satire upon it
- D. Its adaptation into a popular play

Answer: C

Q3. Which of the following is one of Southey's immense narrative poems?

- A. The Lay of the Last Minstrel
- B. Thalaba the Destroyer
- C. Christabel
- D. The Ancient Mariner

Answer: B

Q4. Southey's long narrative poems are historically important because they show the tendency of the romantic movement to:

- A. Revert to purely domestic and urban settings
- B. Carry the poet further afield in quest of fresh, picturesque objects
- C. Abandon poetry entirely for prose
- D. Focus exclusively on religious theology

Answer: B

Q5. 'Thalaba the Destroyer' was written in which form?

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- A. Heroic couplets
- B. Spenserian stanzas
- C. Unrhymed verses of varying length and metrical structure
- D. Strict classical hexameters

Answer: C

Q6. The verse form of Southey's 'Thalaba' served as a model for which famous poem by Shelley?

- A. Ozymandias
- B. Ode to the West Wind
- C. Queen Mab
- D. Adonais

Answer: C

Q7. Which poet is described as a classic writing in a romantic age, whose classicism was of the genuine Greek kind?

- A. Thomas Campbell
- B. Walter Savage Landor
- C. Samuel Rogers
- D. Robert Southey

Answer: B

Q8. Did Walter Savage Landor ever become widely popular?

- A. Yes, he was the most popular poet of his day
- B. No, he gained an 'audience fit though few'
- C. Only in France
- D. Only after he wrote novels

Answer: B

Q9. Which of these works was written by Landor?

- A. Gebir
- B. Thalaba
- C. Madoc
- D. Hohenlinden

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Answer: A

Q10. According to Sir Henry Taylor, Landor lived in a past world of heroic thought and passed nearly through the most eventful century:

- A. Becoming a famous revolutionary leader
- B. Altering his style every decade
- C. Without learning from experience, and almost without adding to his ideas
- D. Writing only satirical poems

Answer: C

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Page 191 - Campbell and Moore

Q1. Thomas Campbell's early poem 'The Pleasures of Hope' (1799) is written in which style and form?

- A. Blank verse with romantic diction
- B. The closed couplet of the outgoing Augustan school
- C. Spenserian stanza
- D. Free verse

Answer: B

Q2. Despite its conventional diction, Campbell's 'The Pleasures of Hope' contains a good deal of:

- A. Satire on religion
- B. Revolutionary feeling
- C. Defense of the monarchy
- D. Oriental mysticism

Answer: B

Q3. In which poem did Campbell use the Spenserian stanza and appear 'almost romantic'?

- A. Theodoric
- B. Pleasures of Hope
- C. Gertrude of Wyoming
- D. Lochiel

Answer: C

Q4. Which of the following is one of Campbell's vigorous war lyrics?

- A. The Holly Tree
- B. Ye Mariners of England
- C. Lalla Rookh
- D. Lord Ullin's Daughter

Answer: B

Q5. Which poet wrote the oriental tale 'Lalla Rookh'?

- A. Thomas Campbell
- B. Thomas Moore

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- C. Lord Byron
- D. Walter Savage Landor

Answer: B

Q6. 'Lalla Rookh' was written in a style for which public taste had been prepared by Moore's friend:

- A. Samuel Rogers
- B. Percy Bysshe Shelley
- C. Lord Byron
- D. Walter Scott

Answer: C

Q7. Moore is chiefly remembered today and shows his best work in which collection?

- A. Lalla Rookh
- B. Irish Melodies
- C. Gertrude of Wyoming
- D. Pleasures of Hope

Answer: B

Q8. Thomas Moore has been aptly called:

- A. The last of our minstrels
- B. The Ettrick Shepherd
- C. The Marvelous Boy
- D. The Peasant Poet

Answer: A

Q9. While Moore had a genuine lyric gift, his verse often lacks:

- A. Rhyme and meter
- B. Depth of feeling, being pervaded by a sentimentalism that has not worn well
- C. Melodic quality
- D. Popular appeal during his own lifetime

Answer: B

Q10. Of all the writers named in this section, who is noted as probably the most attractive to the general

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reader today?

- A. Samuel Rogers
- B. William Lisle Bowles
- C. Thomas Moore
- D. Robert Southey

Answer: C